

Parent & Tutor Handoff: Reagan Higgs

Prepared: April 2026 | **For:** Anyone supporting Reagan at home or in tutoring.

Essentials

Item	Detail
Full Name	Reagan Elizabeth Higgs
DOB	05/30/2015 (age 10, turns 11 in May)
Current Grade	5th
Primary Parent	Kathryn (Katy) Higgs — spear.cpt@gmail.com — 513-926-5808
Father	Blake Higgs — blakehiggs@hotmail.com — 513-903-6553
Reagan’s Google	reaganhiggs910@gmail.com (parent-managed via Family Link)
Reagan’s School Google	Reagan.higgs33@ihsd.us (use for Classroom/Drive assignment access)
IEP Category	Other Health Impairment (Anxiety & Depression)
Diagnoses	Generalized Anxiety, Depression
Medication	Sertraline 25mg (½ pill daily, since Dec 2024)

Care Team

Role	Name	Contact
Therapist (lead)	Ali Hill, LSW — The Anxiety Center	alirentschler@theanxietycenter.com · 513-547-2861
School-based Therapist	Samantha Rust, MSW, LISW-S — Cincinnati Children's	samantha.rust@cchmc.org · 513-706-2278
CCHMC PHP Coordinator	Marisa Nyerges — CCHMC	via referral email thread
Previous IS Teacher	Taylor McConney (Madeira)	—
5th Grade Teacher	Mrs. Wanstrath (IHES)	—
Current IS Teacher (IHES)	Kelsey Marlow	—

What Works (Do These)

1. **Start every session with an emotional check-in** (scale of 1-10). If 7+, shorten the block.
2. **Break tasks into tiny pieces.** “Just do this one problem, then we’ll decide.”
3. **Use graphic organizers for all writing.** Always.
4. **Read math/writing prompts aloud.** Her reading is fine; comprehension spikes when she doesn’t have to decode under pressure.
5. **Celebrate effort and growth, not correctness.** “I noticed you kept going even when it was hard.”
6. **Let her help someone younger or teach back a concept.** This is a huge confidence builder.
7. **Offer real-world applications and outdoor science.** Crystals, bird watching, cooking.

8. **Use her interests as hooks:** Roblox, preppy fashion, pets (Dutch), shopping, helping kindergarteners.

What Doesn't Work (Avoid)

1. **Public correction** or drawing attention to her struggles in front of others.
2. **Surprise or pop-quiz style tasks** with no prep.
3. **Large, unbroken writing assignments** on the computer (typing is a specific challenge).
4. **Pressuring her to explain her feelings** when she's already escalated — give space first.
5. **Penalizing missed work** when anxiety was the cause — reschedule without judgment.
6. **Timed tests without extended-time accommodation.**
7. **Saying "You're fine" or "There's nothing to worry about."** Validate first.

Daily Must-Haves (Accommodations)

- Small-group or 1-on-1 setting for instruction.
- Extended time (up to 50%) on all assessments.
- Multiplication chart, number line, manipulatives always visible.
- Graphic organizers printed and ready.
- Noise-cancelling headphones / fidget / calming corner available.
- Frequent check-ins ("How's your brain doing?").
- Submission via photo or Google Doc to the adult analytics dashboard — **not** Google Classroom.

Warning Signs (Intervene Early)

- Morning resistance, stomach aches, or "I'm stupid" statements.
- Going quiet, putting head down, or asking for the bathroom repeatedly.

- Tearing up paper, scribbling over her own work.
- Asking for a lot of reassurance (“Is this right? Is this right?”).
- Refusing to start a task.

Response: Pause. Offer a break, a drink, Dutch cuddles, or 5 minutes of drawing. Then come back smaller.

Recommended Tools

- **Math:** Khan Academy (5th grade), IXL, Prodigy.
- **Reading:** Epic!, ReadTheory, ReadWorks, printable fluency passages.
- **Writing:** Google Docs with voice-typing, Storyworks, Spelling City.
- **Science/Social Studies:** Mystery Science, BrainPOP, Crash Course Kids, iCivics, Merlin Bird ID.
- **Reward:** Roblox, Pinterest boards for room/fashion, 1:1 time with mom or Dutch.